UNIVERSITY OF THE WITWATERSRAND, JOHANNESBURG | WSoE Wits School of Education

WITS AHEAD RESEARCH GROUP

The AHEAD Fortnightly

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Kule veki mbini ezidlulileyo, ingxoxo iqhubekile ukusuka kubuzo bokuba ngaba abafundi basebenzisa i-AI, isiya kubuzo bokuba basebenzisa njani kakuhle: uphononongo olutsha oluvela kwiOstreliya, uMzantsi Afrika neNigeria luvumelana ngelithi umkhwa nokunzulu kokuzibandakanya, kungekhona ukufikelela okulula okanye indlela ekubhalwe ngayo umgaqo-nkqubo, kuxele ukufunda okungcono kunye nethemba elingcono labaphumeleleyo izidanga. Amaziko aphendula ngendlela ezahlukeneyo: amanye abuyela kuviwo lobuso ngobuso kunye nemigaqo eqinileyo ngokuqhatha, amanye, kuquka iWits ngeziko layo elitsha, iGlobal Higher Education Futures Centre, akhetha ukwakha indlela yokufundisa kunye nesakhono sophando esikhundleni soko. Amanani ekota yesithathu evela kwiStatistics South Africa asikhumbuza ukuba kutheni oku kubalulekile apha: intswela-ngqesho yolutsha yehle kancinci ukuya kuma-47.3%, ngako oko imbuyekezo yeyure nganye yokufunda isamele ifunyanwe. Kwi-Wits AHEAD, umsebenzi uhlala ufanayo: ukunceda abaphumeleleyo izidanga baguqule isakhono, kungekhona ukufikelela kuphela, abe lithuba.

IZINTO EZINTATHU EKUFUNEKA UZAZI

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NEWS · 11 NOVEMBER 2026 · UNITED KINGDOM

Office for Students tells universities to bring back in-person exams to protect assessment from AI

I-Office for Students yaseNgilani ibongoza iiyunivesithi ukuba ziphinde zicinge ngokubuyela kuviwo olwenziwa ngqo nolungavumeli iincwadi, uviwo lomlomo kunye nemisebenzi yezenzo, ukwenzela ukuba uvavanyo luhlale lusebenza kakuhle ngoxa ubukrelekrele bokwenziwa (i-AI) busanda ngamandla. Lo mgaqo-nkqubo ulandela uphononongo lweenyanga ezine olwenziwe nombutho i-Advance HE, olususelwa kwiingxoxo nabafundi kunye nabasebenzi abalingana ne-300 kwiziko ezingaphezulu kwe-120, lwafumanisa ukuba ukusetyenziswa kwe-AI kusanda kakhulu, kwaye ezinye iindlela zovavanyo azisalungele injongo yazo. Yeyokuqala apho umlawuli achaze izenzo zamaziko ezisebenzisa i-AI ezinokubangela ukungenelela, kuquka ukunikwa isidanga esiphantsi.

> **Kutheni kubalulekile:** Intsika yokuqala ye-Wits AHEAD yi-AI evelisayo kwimfundo ephakamileyo, kuquka uvavanyo kunye nengqibelelo yezemfundo; umlawuli kazwelonke oshukumela ukususka esilulekweni ukuya kwiziphumo ezinyanzelekileyo ngomthetho ngumqondiso wokuba ezinye iinkqubo, kuquka eyoMzantsi Afrika, zinganokuwuqwalasela ngononophelo.

Times Higher Education · timeshighereducation.com · **Funda kumthombo**

Luckhurst, G. (2026, November 11). OfS pushes in-person exams to 'protect sector's reputation'. *Times Higher Education*. timeshighereducation.com/news/ofs-pushes-person-exams-protect-sectors-reputation

2

REPORT · 11 NOVEMBER 2026 · UNITED KINGDOM

Graduates' wellbeing and civic contribution should be tracked alongside pay, British Academy argues

I-British Academy ithi imilinganiselo yangoku yempumelelo yabaphumelele izidanga igxila kakhulu kumvuzo wenyanga kuphela, kwaye ifuna ukuba ulungelelwaniso lwempilo nomsebenzi, impilo yexesha elide kunye nokubandakanyeka kwasentlalweni nako kulandelelwe. Ikhombisa uphononongo lurhulumente olufumene ukuba iipesenti ezingama-24 zabo baphumelele izidanga zenza umsebenzi wokuzithandela ngokusesikweni ubuncinane kanye ngenyanga, kuthelekiswa neepesenti ezingama-17 zabo bangaphumeleliyo izidanga, kwaye icebisa ukudibanisa idatha yemfundo ephakamileyo kunye needatha zempilo nolwaphulo-mthetho ukwenza umfanekiso opheleleyo ngakumbi.

> **Kutheni kubalulekile:** Intsika yesine ye-Wits AHEAD igubungela isakhono nokuqesheka kwabaphumelele izidanga ngaphaya komsebenzi wokuqala; umfutho wombutho kazwelonke wokufuna imilinganiselo yeziphumo ebanzi uthetha ngokuthe ngqo kwindlela i-Wits AHEAD eyichaza ngayo 'impumelelo' kubafundi bayo.

British Academy, reported by Times Higher Education · timeshighereducation.com · **Funda kumthombo**

Luckhurst, G. (2026, November 11). Graduates' work-life balance 'should be tracked alongside pay'. *Times Higher Education*. timeshighereducation.com/news/graduates-work-life-balance-should-be-tracked-alongside-pay

3

REPORT · 10 NOVEMBER 2026 · SOUTH AFRICA

Youth unemployment eases slightly to 47.3% as overall unemployment rises to 33.7% in the third quarter of 2026

Izinga elisemthethweni lentswela-ngqesho linyuke ngamanqaku epesenti ali-0.1 laya kuma-33.7% kwikota yesithathu ka-2026, ngoxa uqeshwa lwanda ngabantu aba-101,000 ukuya kwizigidi ezi-16.8, kodwa umsebenzi usanda ngokukhawuleza ngakumbi. Intswela-ngqesho yolutsha (iminyaka 15 ukuya ku-34) yehla ngamanqaku ali-0.1 ukuya kuma-47.3%: ulutsha olungaqeshwanga lwehla nga-23,000 ukuya kwizigidi ezi-5.0, ngelixa ulutsha oluqeshiweyo lwehla nga-5,000 ukuya kwizigidi ezi-5.5.

> **Kutheni kubalulekile:** Eli linani iqela elilisebenzisayo kwiindlela zabafundi abafundela ezidanga nakutshintsho olunobulungisa. Umba 4 ubuza ukuba i-AI iyasihla okanye iyasandisa esi sithuba kweli qela ngqo.

Statistics South Africa · statssa.gov.za · **Funda kumthombo**

Statistics South Africa. (2026, November 10). *Quarterly Labour Force Survey (QLFS): Q3 2026* [Press release]. statssa.gov.za/publications/P0211/Media%20Release%20QLFS%20Q3%202026.pdf

UPHANDO NEENGXELO

Wits opens a Global Higher Education Futures Centre, with a dedicated generative AI pedagogy hub

University of the Witwatersrand · 9 November 2026 · Pillar 6: Responsible AI and policy. KwiNtsika 6, iyunivesithi yaseMzantsi Afrika iyakha olwayo uqongqo lokucinga ngokuphazamiseka kwe-AI kwimfundo ephakamileyo, kunokuba ithabathe olwenziwe kwindawo yimbi, nto leyo ingxaki yoMzantsi weHlabathi engagqibelelekayo esekelwe kulungelelwaniso i-Wits AHEAD ikhona ukuyixhasa.

University of the Witwatersrand. (2026, November 9). Wits launches the Global Higher Education Futures Centre. wits.ac.za/news/latest-news/research-news/2026/2026-11/wits-launches-the-global-higher-education-futures-centre.html

AI-generated 'slop' papers published under prominent academics' names without their consent

Times Higher Education · 9 November 2026 · Pillar 6: Responsible AI and policy. Kwintsika 6, lo mcimbi ubonisa indlela i-AI evelisayo enganokusetyenziswa ngayo ukwenza amaxoki ongekuko kuphela kwiziphumo zophando, kodwa nobunikazi lwabo babaphandi, kungoko umgaqo-nkqubo we-AI enoxanduva kwimfundo ephakamileyo ufanele usonwabise ukunyaniseka kukupapashwa, ingagcini kwigumbi lokufunda.

Asaf, S. (2026, November 9). 'AI slop' papers published under prominent academics' names. *Times Higher Education*. timeshighereducation.com/news/ai-slop-papers-published-under-prominent-academics-names

Wording of university generative AI policies shapes how students and teachers actually behave, study finds

arXiv preprint (University of Maryland and University of Iowa researchers) · 8 November 2026 · Pillar 1: Generative AI in higher education. KwiNtsika 1, lo phando sikhumbuza ukuba umgaqo-nkqubo we-AI evelisayo ulungile kuphela ngokulingana nolwimi lwawo: iiyunivesithi ezibhala okanye ezihlaziya imigaqo yazo yesebenzisa i-AI kufundisa nakuvavanyo, kufuneka zivavanye ingekuphela nto umgaqo ovumela, kodwa indlela abafundi nabasebenzi abaza kufunda baze basebenze ngamagama lawo uqobo.

Mehreen, S., Yuan, X., Nithyanand, R., & Hoque, N. (2026). *Wording matters: Understanding how GenAI policy rules shape teachers' and students' workflows and perceptions*. arXiv. arxiv.org/abs/2611.11072

How deeply students engage with an AI chat, not how often they use it, predicts better coursework, large Australian study finds

University of Queensland and Monash University (arXiv preprint, submitted to the Journal of Computer Assisted Learning) · 8 November 2026 · Pillar 2: Analytics for student success. KwiNtsika 2, lo mfumaniso ubalulekile kuzo zonke iziko ezakha uhlalutyo malunga nokusetyenziswa kwe-AI: ukubala ukufuthi abafundi bavula ikhetshbhothi kuthetha kancinci ngokufunda, ngoko iinqubo eziyilelwe ukuxhasa impumelelo yabafundi kufuneka zijonge ubunzulu bokubandakanyeka, kungekhona ukufutha kokucofa.

Zhuang, X., Bakharia, A., Gašević, D., & Khosravi, H. (2026). *From dialogue to task: How cognitive engagement with generative artificial intelligence relates to post-dialogue activity and task outcomes*. arXiv. arxiv.org/abs/2611.11435

BUKELA

▶ World Bank video: 'small AI', not big models alone, can widen opportunity in developing-economy education and jobs (1 hr 16 min)

World Bank Group (YouTube). Kwindibano yeHlabathi malunga ne-i-AI kunye noMnxeba, eSeoul, eqhutywe yiWorld Bank Group, uMongameli wayo u-Ajay Banga wavula iqonga malunga nendlela amaxhoba e-"i-AI encinci", asebenzisekayo kwaye alungelelaniswe nemeko yasekhaya, kungekhona kuphela iimodeli ezinkulu ngokubanzi, anganika amathuba kumazwe aphuhlayo. UMphathiswa wezoNxibelelwano, uBuvelwano kunye noQoqosho olungumxholo waseNigeria, uBosun Tijani, wadibana noMphathi oyiNtloko yeTridge, uHoshik Shin, kunye nomseki we-Amini, uKate Kallot, ukuxoxa ngemfundo, ulimo kunye neenkonzo zoluntu, kunye necandelo elithetha ngezifundo ezifunyenwe ekusetyenzisweni kwe-i-AI kwimfundo eEl Salvador. Iqonga lithethe ngedatha yasekhaya ethembakeleyo, unxibelelwano olufikelelekayo, amandla okubala, izakhono kunye neendlela zokuthenga njengeemeko ezivumela abaqambi bendawo ukwandisa izisombululo zabo ze-i-AI.

UKUSUKA KWIQELA

12 Septemba 2026 **Ubudlelwane: iOstreliya ijoyina imaphu yeFootprint, intsebenziswano kunye neYunivesithi yaseMurdoch, ePerth, iseyenziwa**
Uphononongo lomsebenzi odibanisiweyo kwi-AI nemfundo phakathi kweWits neMurdoch; isivumelwano sokuqondana silungiselelwa.

12 Septemba 2026 **Ingxelo yophando lwesidanga seMasters igqitywe ngomqondiso ophambili; umgqibeleli uza kuphumelela ngoDisemba 2026**
Uphononongo lwebhiblyometriki lobunkokeli olususelwa kwidatha kunye nokuyilwa komgaqo-nkqubo; umgqibeleli ngoku uqhubela kwisindululo sedoctoral.

12 Septemba 2026 **Ithisisi yedoctoral igqitywe; umgqibeleli uza kuphumelela ngoDisemba 2026**
Ulungiso olufunwayo ngababuzi lwamkelwe kuphononongo malunga nabafundi bokufunda bekude abaphumelele kakhulu kwimfundo ephakamileyo yaseMpuma Afrika.

INTO ESIYICEBISAYO UKUBA IFUNDWE

Development as Freedom Amartya Sen, Oxford University Press (1999). Le yi-H ekwi-AHEAD. Qala apha.

With best wishes for the fortnight ahead,

Director: Wits AHEAD

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